

Selected Stocchi

by C.G.S.Narayanan

The initial years after the second world war opened up a new era in the development of the two- move chess problem, with theme of changed mates after certain black moves coming into prominence. One of the outstanding composers during the period was the Italian maestro Ottavio Stocchi (1906-1964) who reigned supreme in the early fifties. He produced a large number of classic compositions which included 124 prizes and many awards in the period 1950 to 1955. Dual avoidance in self blocks on a square was named after him. I present here three of his masterpieces quoted in the book 'Selected Stocchi' by Luciano Citeroni and Geoff Foster'.

O.Stocchi

5th HM, The Hindu 1953



Mate in two moves

Set: 1...b2 2.Qe5

Key 1.Qh3 (2.Rxf7)

1...fxg6 2.Rf8; 1...f6 2.Re5

1...Bf6+ 2.Rg5; 1..Ncd5 2.Nc5(Nd8?)

1...Nbd6 2.Nd8(Nc5?) 1...Nd4 2.Qe3 (Re2?) 1..d4 2.Re2? (Qe3?)

A fine key clears the way for an unexpected cross-check and three other battery mates including the threat. Defences on d6 lead to self blocks with dual avoidance by black line opening. Furthermore, two black moves to d4 lead to double interference mates again with dual

avoidance. A marvellous traditional problem with three distinct main themes

Ottavio Stocchi

First prize, Arbeider Skak 1951/1



Mate in two moves

1...N any 2.Qe5; 1...Nd6 2.Qh8

Try 1.Qb3?(Qxc4) N any 2.Qd5

1...Nb6 2.Nc6 but 1...Bxd3!

Key 1.Qb5 (2.Qxc4) N any 2.Nb3

1...Nd2 2.Nxe2; 1..Bf7/Bf5+ 2.Nf5

A three phase problem with a constant random defence but a different black correction move in each phase. A fine refutation to the try caps this lovely composition

A Stocchi Meredith for solving

O.Stocchi

I prize, Meredith Ty,

Norsk vanforetidskrift 1954



Mate in two moves

Solution to problem for solving in the article 'Loshinski's masterpieces'

Key: 1.Rb1! (2.d4) 1...Bb2/Rb2

2.Qf2/Qxc3; 1...Be6/Re6

2.Bd6/Nd7; 1...Bg4/Rg4 2.Bg1/Ne6

Triple Grimshaw in an elegant setting

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